

Employee or Other Affected Individual Breach Notification

Sample Texas Chapter 521 notice for sensitive personal information

OWNER Human Resources + Legal + Communications	DISTRICT Ardent ISD	REVIEW CYCLE Annual + after major incident	POLICY CROSS-REFERENCE CQB personnel records Incident Response Plan
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Training Sample - Customize Before Use. This document is an instructional artifact for Ardent ISD. It should be aligned to current board policy, administrative procedures, cyber-insurance requirements, records-retention requirements, and advice of district legal counsel before operational use. Legal and reporting requirements can change.

Sample Notice - AISD-IR-2026-007

Date: June 3, 2026
To: Affected Current/Formal Employee
Subject: Notice of Data Security Incident

Dear Ardent ISD Employee or Former Employee,

Ardent Independent School District is notifying you of a data security incident that may have involved some of your personal information. This notice explains what happened, the information involved, the steps the district has taken, and actions you may consider.

What happened

On May 18, 2026, Ardent ISD discovered that an external account had gained unauthorized access to a vendor support workspace used during a human-resources data migration. The district immediately restricted access, notified its cybersecurity response partners, and began an investigation.

The investigation determined that a file placed in the workspace for migration troubleshooting was accessible to the unauthorized account for a limited period. The district has no evidence at this time that the information has been used for identity theft, but because the file was accessible, we are notifying affected individuals.

What information was involved

The file contained:

- employee name;

- employee identification number; and
- Social Security number.

The file did **not** contain district passwords, direct-deposit account numbers, or medical/benefit information.

What we are doing

Ardent ISD has:

- removed the file and terminated the unauthorized access path;
- reset and restricted vendor support access;
- engaged cybersecurity and legal response support;
- reported the incident through applicable Texas cybersecurity and data-breach reporting channels;
- begun a review of data-transfer and vendor-support procedures; and
- arranged **12 months of identity monitoring and identity restoration support** for affected individuals at no cost. Enrollment instructions are included with this notice.

Steps you can consider

You may wish to monitor financial accounts and credit reports for activity you do not recognize. You may also consider a fraud alert or security freeze with the nationwide consumer reporting agencies. The enclosed identity-monitoring information provides additional instructions and support contacts.

For more information

Please contact the Ardent ISD incident support center using the number provided in your mailed or verified-email notice. Do not send your Social Security number or other sensitive information through ordinary email.

Sincerely,

Cameron Ortiz

Chief Human Resources Officer
Ardent Independent School District

Sample Compliance Record for This Notice

Item	Sample entry
Incident discovered	May 18, 2026
District determined Chapter 521 breach occurred	May 22, 2026
Texas residents affected	486
TXCC initial report	May 19, 2026
Texas AG electronic report	June 1, 2026

Item	Sample entry
Individual notice begins	June 3, 2026
Identity-monitoring period	12 months
Law enforcement	Counsel documents whether engaged

The sample assumes legal counsel determined that Texas Business & Commerce Code Chapter 521 applies and that at least 250 Texas residents were affected. Under the current statute, the OAG report must include specified incident information and counts, and individual notice generally must occur without unreasonable delay and no later than 60 days after the breach determination, subject to statutory exceptions.

Customization Checklist

- ☐ Use the exact data categories supported by the investigation.
- ☐ Confirm the date of “determination” with legal counsel; do not automatically use discovery date.
- ☐ Confirm Texas resident count and OAG threshold.
- ☐ Coordinate state notices, insurer/breach counsel, and any multi-state notice obligations.
- ☐ Use secure methods for enrollment codes and identity-monitoring details.
- ☐ Provide alternate-language and accessible notices where appropriate.
- ☐ Preserve proof of mailing/email/direct notice.

References

- Texas Business & Commerce Code Chapter 521 - Identity Theft Enforcement and Protection Act
- Texas Government Code Chapter 2063 - Texas Cyber Command (see § 2063.302)
- Texas Cyber Command - Report a Cybersecurity Incident
- TASB - School Cybersecurity: Security Breach Notification and Response